# LAZARUS SAMSON YUNANA

IMPACT, RESEARCH, MEAL & INFORMATION MANAGEMENT SPECIALIST

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## EXECUTIVE PROFILE

Monitoring, Evaluation, Research, Accountability, Learning (MERL), Impact Measurement and Information Management Specialist with over eight years of progressive experience leading evidence generation, research, programme quality, and information management for humanitarian and development programmes across Nigeria. Experienced in designing and strengthening MERL systems, leading mixed-method research and evaluations, developing information management solutions, and translating complex data into actionable insights that improve programme quality, accountability, and strategic decision-making.

Extensive experience supporting multi-sector programmes in education, protection, governance, resilience, food security, livelihoods, WASH, and humanitarian response funded by USAID, the European Union, FCDO, ECHO, NHF, and other international partners. Demonstrated expertise in research design, impact measurement, organizational learning, adaptive management, Protection Information Management (PIM), data quality assurance, Power BI dashboard development, GIS mapping, and digital information systems.

Currently serving as Protection Sector Information Management Specialist with the Danish Refugee Council, providing technical leadership for protection information management, evidence generation, analytical reporting, and coordination with national humanitarian information management structures. Recognized for strengthening organizational learning systems, improving data quality, building partner capacity, and producing high-quality evidence that informs programme strategy, advocacy, and operational decision-making.

## CAREER HIGHLIGHTS

- More than 8 years of progressive leadership experience in MERL, research, information management, and programme quality across humanitarian and development contexts.
- Led and supported 20+ research studies, assessments, evaluations, and protection monitoring exercises across Northeast and Northwest Nigeria.
- Designed and strengthened MERL, information management, and accountability systems supporting large-scale humanitarian and development programmes across 70+ Local Government Areas.
- Developed interactive dashboards, GIS products, analytical reports, and evidence products that strengthened programme monitoring, donor reporting, and evidence-based decision-making.
- Delivered technical assistance and capacity strengthening to government institutions, humanitarian partners, implementing organizations, and field teams on research methodologies, MEAL systems, digital data collection, information management, and data analytics.
- Contributed to national humanitarian analysis through participation in the Protection Sector Information Management Technical Working Group and the Protection Monitoring and Analysis Cell (PMAC).
- Extensive experience working with complex datasets using Power BI, KoboToolbox, ActivityInfo, Excel, SPSS, Stata, and GIS platforms to generate actionable insights for programme improvement.

## CORE COMPETENCIES

**Impact Measurement & Research**

- Mixed-Methods Research
- Baseline, Midline & Endline Evaluations
- Needs Assessments
- Protection Monitoring
- Programme Evaluation
- Impact Measurement
- Quantitative & Qualitative Analysis
- Sampling Design
- Research Quality Assurance

**MERL & Programme Quality**

- Results Frameworks
- Theory of Change
- Logical Framework Development
- Performance Monitoring Plans
- Indicator Development
- Data Quality Assessments
- Organizational Learning
- Adaptive Management
- Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP)
- Management

**Information Management & Analytics**

- Protection Information Management (PIM)
- Information Management Systems
- Database Design & Management
- Power BI Dashboard Development
- GIS Mapping & Spatial Analysis
- Data Visualization
- Data Governance
- Evidence Generation
- Automated Reporting

**Leadership & Coordination**

- Technical Leadership
- Capacity Strengthening
- Team Mentoring
- Stakeholder Engagement
- Inter-Agency Coordination
- Technical Working Groups
- Partner Support
- Knowledge

## TECHNICAL EXPERTISE

**Research & Evaluation**

- Research Design
- Survey Methodology
- FGDs
- KIIs
- Outcome Evaluation
- Impact Assessment
- Data Quality Assurance

**Information Management**

- Power BI
- KoboToolbox
- ActivityInfo
- ODK
- CommCare
- Microsoft Excel (Advanced)
- GIS
- Database Management

**Statistical & Analytical Software**

- SPSS
- Stata
- Power BI
- Tableau
- Python (Foundational)

**Data Visualization**

- Interactive Dashboards
- GIS Mapping
- Infographics
- Analytical Reports
- Information Products

## EXPERIENCE

**Protection Sector Information Management (PIM) Specialist**

**Danish Refugee Council (DRC), Nigeria | Abuja, Nigeria** **July 2025 – Present**

Lead the design, implementation, and continuous improvement of Protection Information Management systems supporting evidence-based protection programming across Nigeria. Provide technical leadership for protection data management, analysis, reporting, and information products while ensuring compliance with global Protection Information Management principles, data protection standards, and inter-agency coordination mechanisms.

**Key Achievements**

- Lead the development and management of Protection Information Management systems supporting protection monitoring, assessments, referrals, and evidence generation across multiple operational locations.
- Design and maintain integrated information management solutions, including Power BI dashboards, Kobo-based data collection systems, databases, GIS products, and automated reporting tools that improve data accessibility and programme decision-making.
- Coordinate the production of analytical reports, protection trend analyses, information products, and visualizations used by programme teams, senior management, donors, and humanitarian coordination platforms.
- Strengthen data quality assurance processes through standardized tools, validation protocols, and routine data quality reviews, improving the reliability and consistency of protection information.
- Provide technical leadership to protection teams and implementing partners on information management, data analysis, protection monitoring methodologies, and evidence-based programming.
- Represent the organization within national and regional Protection Information Management coordination mechanisms, contributing to harmonized approaches, common standards, and sector-wide evidence generation.
- Support the development and refinement of protection monitoring tools, standard operating procedures, indicator frameworks, and information-sharing protocols to strengthen organizational learning and programme quality.
- Collaborate with programme, MEAL, and protection teams to ensure protection evidence informs programme adaptation, advocacy priorities, and strategic planning.

**Monitoring, Evaluation, Research, Learning and Adaptation (MERLA) Specialist**

**Creative Associates International | Adamawa, Nigeria** **June 2024 – March 2025**

Provided technical leadership for monitoring, evaluation, research, learning, and adaptive management across a USAID-funded education programme, strengthening evidence systems supporting programme implementation across seven states.

**Key Achievements**

- Led the design and implementation of MERLA systems supporting programme monitoring, evidence generation, and adaptive management across more than 1,000 schools.
- Developed performance monitoring frameworks, indicator reference sheets, data collection tools, and reporting systems aligned with donor requirements and programme objectives.
- Coordinated major education assessments, including EGRA, EGMA, ASER, LEMA, GALA, Institutional Capacity Assessments, Stakeholder Network Analysis, and Political Economy Analysis, ensuring methodological rigor and high-quality evidence generation.

- Produced analytical reports, dashboards, and data visualizations that informed programme implementation, donor reporting, and strategic decision-making.
- Strengthened programme data quality through routine verification exercises, data quality assessments, and continuous improvement of data management processes.
- Facilitated learning workshops, technical review meetings, and evidence reflection sessions that promoted adaptive programming and knowledge sharing.
- Delivered technical assistance and capacity strengthening to government stakeholders, implementing partners, and project staff on research methods, digital data collection, and results-based management.
- Supported donor compliance by ensuring timely reporting, documentation, and evidence synthesis across programme interventions.

**Research, Study and Data Officer**

**Creative Associates International | Adamawa, Nigeria** **January 2023 – June 2024**

Led research coordination, study implementation, and evidence generation activities supporting education system strengthening and programme design.

**Key Achievements**

- Coordinated quantitative and qualitative research studies from design through dissemination, ensuring robust methodologies and high-quality analytical outputs.
- Managed large programme datasets, establishing quality assurance processes that improved data reliability and accessibility for programme teams.
- Conducted statistical analysis and evidence synthesis to generate actionable recommendations for programme improvement.
- Developed research reports, dashboards, briefing notes, and visualization products supporting evidence-informed planning.
- Strengthened institutional research capacity through training, mentoring, and technical support to field teams and implementing partners.
- Contributed to programme learning by translating complex research findings into practical recommendations for programme adaptation.

**Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning Officer**

**International Rescue Committee (IRC) | Adamawa & Borno, Nigeria** **September 2022 – January 2023**

Provided technical leadership for monitoring, evaluation, and learning systems supporting humanitarian response programmes across Borno and Adamawa States.

**Key Achievements**

- Led baseline, midline, and endline evaluations using mixed-method approaches to assess programme performance and outcomes.
- Designed monitoring tools, reporting frameworks, and performance tracking systems that strengthened programme accountability and evidence generation.
- Coordinated data quality assessments, field verification exercises, and performance reviews to improve reporting accuracy and donor confidence.
- Facilitated organizational learning through periodic reflection sessions, performance reviews, and evidence-sharing meetings.
- Managed enumerator recruitment, training, supervision, and quality assurance for large-scale data collection exercises.

**Regional Accountability Lead**

**Solidarités International | Borno, Nigeria** **November 2021 – August 2022**

Led Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP) systems across Northeast and Northwest Nigeria, strengthening community engagement, accountability, and programme responsiveness.

**Key Achievements**

- Designed and institutionalized community feedback and complaints mechanisms across multiple operational locations.
- Established accountability information systems and dashboards enabling real-time monitoring of community concerns and programme responsiveness.
- Conducted trend analyses of community feedback to inform programme adaptation and operational decision-making.
- Built staff capacity on AAP standards, complaint management, safeguarding, and community engagement.
- Integrated accountability data into organizational learning and programme quality improvement processes.

**Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning Officer**

**Solidarités International | Borno, Nigeria** **February 2021 – October 2021**

- Strengthened organizational MEAL systems through improved data collection, verification, analysis, and reporting.
- Supported programme evaluations, assessments, and monitoring activities across humanitarian interventions.
- Developed reporting tools and quality assurance processes that enhanced data consistency and reporting efficiency.
- Contributed to evidence generation and programme learning through regular performance analysis and review.

**Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning Officer**

**Mercy Vincent Foundation | Borno, Nigeria** **January 2020 – January 2021**

- Designed project monitoring systems, indicator tracking tools, and accountability mechanisms supporting humanitarian programming.
- Led baseline studies, post-distribution monitoring, impact assessments, and routine monitoring activities.
- Strengthened complaints and feedback mechanisms that improved accountability to affected populations.
- Produced high-quality donor reports and analytical products supporting programme decision-making.

**Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning Assistant**

**Mercy Vincent Foundation | Borno, Nigeria** **June 2018 – November 2019**

- Supported implementation of monitoring systems across humanitarian projects.
- Assisted in quantitative and qualitative data collection, analysis, and reporting.
- Conducted routine data verification and contributed to data quality improvement initiatives.
- Trained field teams on digital data collection tools and reporting procedures.

## EDUCATION

Ahmadu Bello University **2026**
**Msc. Information Management**

National Open University of Nigeria **2024**
**Msc. Information Technology**

University of Maiduguri **2019**
**Bsc. Statistics**

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & CERTIFICATIONS

**Monitoring, Evaluation, Research, Accountability & Learning (MERLA)**

- MEAL in Emergencies – Save the Children International
- MEAL for Development Professionals – Humentum
- Accountability and Learning Certificate – Kaya Connect

**Programme Management**

- Program Management for Development Professionals – Humentum

**Data Analytics & Information Management**

- Power BI for Data Analysis and Visualization – Udemy
- Data Science and Analytics – Udemy
- Data Visualization with Tableau – Udemy
- Python Programming – Udemy
- Data Engineering with GCP and Azure Cloud – Udemy

**Safeguarding & Protection**

- Safeguarding in the International Aid Sector – The Open University (FutureLearn)

## PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

- Member, National Protection Sector Information Management Technical Working Group
- Member, National Protection Monitoring and Analysis Cell (PMAC)
- MERL and Information Management Practitioners
- Statistics and Data Analytics Professionals Network
- Monitoring, Evaluation, Research and Learning Community of Practice

## REFERENCES

**Will be available upon request**